

Ben Chesser

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Education

University of North Carolina, Chapel Hill, NC

August 2022 – May 2026

B.S. Computer Science, Minor in Creative Writing

GPA: 3.94

Languages/Technologies

- Swift, Python, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, C, SQL, HTML5/CSS, MATLAB, Verilog
- Claude Code, OpenAI Codex, Perplexity, SwiftUI, React, Angular, FastAPI, SQLAlchemy, HTTP, Nginx, Git, GitHub, Gitlab, Figma, Sketch, Red Hat OpenShift

Experience

Red Hat – Raleigh, NC

June 2026 – Present

Associate Software Engineer

- Engineered core security solutions on Red Hat's **Emerging Technologies team** in the office of the CTO
- Contributed to Project Lightwell, a \$5B joint Red Hat and IBM initiative focused on hardening and protecting global software supply chains
- Mitigated software vulnerabilities by implementing automated dependency analysis, code integrity verification, and infrastructure risk management tooling

Apple Inc. – Austin, TX

May 2025 – Aug 2025

Software Engineering Intern

- Helped design and develop the modernizing rewrite of internal macOS and iPadOS applications
- Learned world-class principles of **collaboration, communication, and full-stack development** in a corporate setting
- Navigated pre-existing codebases to debug internal SwiftUI applications

The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill – Chapel Hill, NC

Aug 2024 – May 2026

Computer Science Teaching Assistant

- Courses Taught: *Systems Fundamentals, Computer Organization*
- Instructed and hosted weekly office hours for classes totaling more than 1000 students
- Developed skills in **teaching and communicating complex ideas**

App Team Carolina – Chapel Hill, NC

May 2024 – May 2026

Chief Executive Officer, iOS Developer, and Product Manager

- Managed a nonprofit that provides students with realistic iOS development experience by partnering with 501(c)(3) nonprofits through the full mobile development process in teams of developers, designers, and product managers
- Designed and directed the initiative to open bootcamps for all university students
- **Managed and mediated projects** in real-world problem-solving scenarios
- Worked with a team to develop applications using technologies including Swift, SwiftUI, Figma, Slack, and Github

Awards

- The [Diane Pozefsky Learning Assistant Award](#) at UNC's 2026 Graduation
- At North Carolina's Largest Hackathon, HackNC:
 - o 2025 - 2nd Place Overall and Capital One Best Financial Hack for SwiftUI app, [Localized](#)
 - o 2024 - Best Game Hack for SwiftUI app, [Magic Missiles](#)
 - o 2022 - Best Mobile Hack for SwiftUI app, [Critttr](#)
- UNC Dean's List for 8 consecutive semesters
- Created social media content achieving over 13 million views
- Awarded for work in highly competitive SNL mentored Sketch Comedy Program

Projects

[PORCH](#) - Swift, SwiftUI, Firebase

May 2024 – May 2026

- Led end-to-end product development for an iOS app, defining requirements, and prioritizing features
- Drove UX and quality through iterative design, analytics-informed decisions, and robust error handling, resulting in a reliable, scalable experience

[CHAIN GAME](#) – React Framework, FastAPI, OpenAI API

August 2024

- Created a free, open source word game that uses GPT AI semantic analysis
- Used React for the frontend with FastAPI connecting the Python backend
- Hosted on a DigitalOcean droplet using nginx